

Board 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 7 3 2
♥ J 9 7 4 3
♦ A 10 6
♣ 9 2

♠ K 10 9 8 6 5

♥ Q

♦ 7 4 2

♣ K Q 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A

♥ 10 8 5 2

♦ 9 8 5 3

♣ A 10 8 7

♠ Q J 4

♥ A K 6

♦ K Q J

♣ J 5 4 3

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South

discarding dummy's ♣K. That's a lot of winners you are wasting but you can afford it.

Only then can you afford to play a ♠. East can win the ♠A, but if he plays a ♣ dummy will be able to over-ruff West.

After you pull trumps you can drive out the ♦A and claim the contract.

As you see, trying even one round of trumps would have been fatal.

You had to get rid of dummy's singleton ♥ first - the fact that it was a winner should not affect your making the correct play.

Partner's 2♥ bid is a transfer so you bid 2♠. Partner now bids 4♠ and you pass.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♣9. East takes the ♣A, then returns the ♣7 on which West plays the ♣2.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 3

Careful! Although it looks like only 3 losers you are in real danger of a ♣ ruff. It is almost certain that West has led a doubleton ♣ so if East can get the lead with either ♠A or ♦A they will get the ruff.

Fortunately your ♦s are solid and you do not need the ♥Q as a winner.

So before playing any trumps play ♥A K,

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 7 2
♥ Q J 10 3
♦ Q J 4
♣ A 7

♠ 5 3

♥ 7 6

♦ 10 5

♣ 9 8 6 5 4 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 8 4

♥ A K 5

♦ 9 8 6 2

♣ Q 10

♠ A 9 6

♥ 9 8 4 2

♦ A K 7 3

♣ K J

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♣
All Pass			
3♣ by South			

Many people play Jacoby Transfer convention. Not all of them play that an initial response of 2♠ asks partner to bid 3♣. You use that here and reply 3♣. Everybody passes.

What a terrible dummy! This shows why this method is a good addition to Jacoby Transfers.

South plays 3♣. West leads the ♥Q. East takes the ♥A K, then switches to the ♠Q.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = ? :: Total = 3 + ?

Instead of trying to estimate how many ♣ losers you may have, just tell yourself that you can only afford to lose one! Then you base your plan on that requirement.

You might as well win the ♠A. You need to play the trumps from dummy and the easiest way to get there is to play ♦A K, then ruff a ♦. Now play a ♣ from dummy and play what from your hand?

You may think it is a guess whether to play the ♣K or ♣J, but there is no guessing involved here. You must play the ♣J because East cannot possibly hold the ♣A. Just go back and look at the bidding again. The East hand failed to open the bidding in first seat. And since then you have seen the ♥A K and the ♠Q come out of the hand. That's 9 points and the ♣A would bring that total to 13. Since he passed it follows that he doesn't have the ♣A. Of course he might or might not have the ♣Q, you just have to hope for that card.

It's easy to forget the bidding once you have started playing a hand.

But good players don't forget, they use every bit of information they can get to help them make their contracts. That's why they make more contracts.

Board 5

South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 8 2
♥ J 6 4
♦ J 7 5
♣ 9 8 7 3

♠ 7 5 4
♥ K 9 7
♦ K 8 6 2
♣ A Q 5



♠ 10 9 6 3
♥ 10 8 5 2
♦ Q 10 9
♣ J 6

♠ A K J
♥ A Q 3
♦ A 4 3
♣ K 10 4 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2NT
Pass	4NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			